

Francisca Castro

CONTACT INFORMATION	Universidad Carlos III de Madrid Departamento de Ciencias Sociales Calle Madrid 135, 28903 Getafe, Madrid Office 18.2.D.09	✉ francisca.castro@uc3m.es Website: francisca-castro.com ☎ 0000-0002-9547-0130 🌐 @fcastrog
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Protests, social movements, state repression, intra-state conflict, political violence, causal inference	
POSITIONS	Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Spain Visiting Professor 2026 - Current	
	International Security & Development Center, Germany Postdoctoral Researcher 2024 - 2025	
	Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Germany Doctoral Fellow 2020 - 2024	
EDUCATION	Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Berlin Graduate School of Social Sciences (BGSS) Ph.D. Political Science (Dr. phil., <i>summa cum laude</i>) 2025 Committee Members: Anselm Hager (Chair), Vera Tröger, Hanna Schwander	
	Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Santiago, Chile M.A. Sociology 2017 B.A. Sociology 2015 B.A. Political Science 2014	
	University of California, Los Angeles Academic Exchange 2012	
PUBLICATIONS	Acevedo, J. & Castro, F. 2026. The Mobilizing Potential of Mass Migration: Experimental Evidence from Honduras. <i>The Journal of Politics</i> . https://doi.org/10.1086/742109 . Shoshan, A., Oser, J. Castro, F. 2026. Social movements and social media: The evolution of scholarship in the age of datafication. <i>Humanities and Social Sciences Communications</i> . https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-026-07128-9 Castro F., Oser, J., Feitosa, F. & Grinberg, N. 2026. External Cues and Policy Preferences: Rethinking the Drivers of Policy Positions. <i>International Journal of Public Opinion and Research</i> , 38(1). https://doi.org/10.1093/ijpor/edaf066 Castro, F. 2025. Deterrence or Defiance? How Severity and Selectivity Shape Protest Responses to Repression. <i>Mobilization</i> , 30(4). https://doi.org/10.17813/1086-671X-30-4-387 Castro, F. & Retamal, R. 2024. Does Electoral Behavior Change After a Protest Cycle? Evidence from Chile and Bolivia. <i>Electoral Studies</i> , 89 (June). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2024.102777	

	Rivera, V. & Castro, F. 2021. Between Social Protests and a Global Pandemic: Working Transitions under the Economic Effects of COVID-19. <i>Social Sciences</i> , 10(4), p.145
	Acevedo, C. & Castro, F. 2015. State Capacity: Perceptions within Chile, in Vanderbilt University (Ed.), <i>Political Culture in Times of Change</i> , Santiago: Latin American Public Opinion Project
WORKING PAPERS	“Guerrilla Shadows on Gender: The Lingering Effects of Peru’s Internal Armed Conflict on Women’s Political Aspirations”. <i>Revise and Resubmit</i> “Violent Conflict and Forced Displacement: Evidence on Social Behavior and Economic Well-Being Among Refugees in Jordan” (with Tilman Brück, Hadi Jaafar and Wolfgang Stojetz). <i>Under Review</i> “Pathways of Negotiated Radicalization: Evidence from Hong Kong and Chile” (with Samson Yuen). <i>Under Review</i> “Understanding Extreme Attitudes: Identity Politics and Social Polarization in Kyrgyzstan” (with Damir Esenaliev, Philipp Schröder, Wolfgang Stojetz and Tilman Brück). <i>Under Review</i> “Memory Sites and Political Preferences: Do Former Dictatorship Detention Centers Influence Far-Right Voting?”. <i>Under Review</i>
WORKS IN PROGRESS	“Countering the Erosion of Trust: Mitigating the Impact of Electoral Fraud Allegations” • Funded by the Electoral Integrity Project Fellowship “Does Social Mobilization on Contentious Issues Affect Citizens’ Evaluations of Political Elites?” (with Jennifer Oser) • Partially funded by APSA Women, Gender & Politics Small Research Grant and Erasmus+ Program, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin “Backlash or Chilling Effect? Attacks on Environmental Activists and Support for Climate Action” (with Winnie Xia) • Funded by Aarhus University Small Grant “Abortion Laws and Institutional Trust: Insights from Mexico’s Legal Shifts” (with Frida Nilsson) “Political Participation and Mass-Elite Congruence in Latin America” (with Jesper Lindqvist and Jennifer Oser)
DATASETS	Castro, F., Oser, J., Feitosa, F., & Grinberg, N. 2025. Replication data for “External Cues and Policy Preferences”. Harvard Dataverse. https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/GDCPDT. [Replication files including an original dataset fielded through the Cooperative Election Survey for the article: Castro, F., Oser, J., Feitosa, F., & Grinberg, N. 2026. External Cues and Policy Preferences: Rethinking the Drivers of Policy Positions. <i>International Journal of Public Opinion Research</i>, 38(1). https://doi.org/10.1093/ijpor/edaf066].
RESEARCH GRANTS	Slicher van Bath de Jong Foundation Fund, 2026, €8,490 Seed funding, Margherita von Brentano Centre for Gender Studies, Free University of Berlin (with Luisa Feline Freier and Maria Böttche), 2026, €5,000 Aarhus University Small Grant (with Winnie Xia), 2025, DDK 38,000 WarEffects Global Fellowship, 2025, €1,500

AWARDS AND FUNDING

External Funding

Fulbright Germany Forschen und Lehren, 2026-27 (Declined)
 Politics & Gender Conference Travel Grant, 2025 (Declined)
 DAAD Kongressreisenprogramm, 2025 (Declined)
 Electoral Integrity Project Junior Fellowship, 2025, CAD \$1,000
 DAAD Mobility with partner countries (KA171), 2024-2027, €20,000
 WCPS Travel Assistance at APSA, 2024, USD \$300
 Midwest Women's Caucus Graduate Travel Award, 2024 (Declined)
 International Studies Association Travel Grant, 2024 (Declined)
 APSA Comparative Politics Section Support Grant, 2023, USD \$500
 APSA Women, Gender & Politics Research Small Research Grants, 2023, USD \$1,000
 DAAD Kongressreisenprogramm, 2023, €1,863
 Travel Grant "Conflict & Change" PhD Workshop, UCL, 2023, £250
 Travel Grant "New Challenges to Democracy" Workshop, University of Montreal, 2022, CAD\$1,000
 Student Sponsorship, Center for Social Conflict and Cohesion Studies, 2017, USD \$1,650
 LASA Travel Grant, 2017, USD \$490
 Center for Social Conflict and Cohesion Studies Scholarship, 2016-2017, USD \$3,300
 Double Major Scholarship, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, 2012-2016, USD \$27,391
 Calbuco Found Scholarship, 2016-2017, USD \$13,915
 University of Bath Travel Grant, November 2015, USD \$1,662
 Brown International Advanced Research Institutes (BARI) Scholarship, June 2015, USD \$287
 Academic Scholarship, Telefónica Chile S.A, 2010, 2014, and 2015, USD \$13,696

Internal Funding

Women's Fund, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2023, €281
 Budget Commission, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2023, €355
 Budget Commission, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2022, €1,125
 Budget Commission, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2022, €450
 Kultur-, Sozial- und Bildungswissenschaftliche Fakultät Funding, Humboldt University, 2021, €417
 Women's Fund, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2021, €634
 Budget Commission, Institute of Social Sciences, Humboldt University, 2021, €1,550
 Kultur-, Sozial- und Bildungswissenschaftliche Fakultät Funding, Humboldt University, 2020, €600
 Academic Exchange Scholarship, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, 2012, USD \$3,085

ACADEMIC TRAINING

Summer School for Women* in Political Methodology, Basel, Switzerland

Web Scraping, Text Analysis, Word Embeddings and Images as Data July, 2023

Dynamics Research Training Group, Berlin, Germany

Image Analysis June, 2023
 Advances in Differences-in-Differences Designs November, 2022

GESIS Leibniz Institut für Sozialwissenschaften, Cologne, Germany

Advanced Bayesian Statistical Modelling in R and Stan October, 2022

Hertie School, Berlin, Germany

Introduction to Teaching in Higher Education March, 2022

University of Essex, UK

Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis July, 2021
 Introduction to Quantitative Text Analysis
 Panel Data Analysis For Comparative Research

RESEARCH
EXPERIENCE

ERC Starting Grant Project “Participation and Representation in the Digital Age (PRD)”

Research Associate

January, 2026 - Current

Postdoctoral Researcher

September, 2023 - December 2025

European Research Council Starting Grant

PI: Prof. Jennifer Oser

Institute of Sociology, Pontificia Universidad Católica, Chile

Research Assistant

May - December 2017

FONDECYT Project 1160921 “The moral economy of meritocracy and redistributive preferences”

Institute of Political Science, Pontificia Universidad Católica, Chile

Research Assistant

December, 2015 - April, 2016

Project “Public Support for Regional Integration in Latin America”

Research Assistant

March, 2013 - March, 2015

FONDECYT Project 1130897 “Web in movement: the students’ movement in Chile and the use of the internet”

Technical Staff

September, 2014 - October, 2015

FONDECYT Project 11130538 “Opening the Black Box for Territorial Party Contestation: The Impact of Subnational Politics in the Americas”

Coordinator Latin American Public Opinion Project

July - December 2014

Millennium Nucleus of Stateness and Democracy in Latin America, Project NS100015

Thesis Student

March - December 2013

FONDECYT Project 1130897 “Web in movement: the students’ movement in Chile and the use of the internet”

School of Political Science, Universidad Diego Portales, Chile

Technical Staff

March - August, 2015

Millennium Nucleus about Critical Citizenship, Polarization of Inequalities, and Institutions: Political Representation of Chile in a Comparative Perspective

Technical Staff

August, 2014 - March, 2015

FONDECYT Project 1140101 “Populism, Constitutionalism and the Politics of Representation: Cross-Regional Patterns”

FIELDWORK

Argentina (October 2023); Republic of Congo (July 2024), Perú (August 2025, Upcoming 2026)

TEACHING

Hertie School of Government, Berlin, Germany

Laboratory Assistant, Statistics II (MA Level), Summer Semester 2023

Laboratory Assistant, Statistics I (MA Level), Winter Semester 2021 & 2023

Humboldt University, Institute of Social Sciences, Berlin, Germany

Lecturer, Comparative Politics and International Relations (BA Basic Course), Winter Semester 2020-2024

Lecturer, Collective Political Violence (BA Specialization Seminar), Summer Semester 2021 & 2023

- Nominated for the Prize for Good Teaching 2023, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin

Lecturer, Conflict in Latin America: A Century of Turmoil (BA Specialization Seminar), Summer Semester 2024

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Spain

Lecturer, Quantitative Techniques in Political Science, 2nd Quarter 2026

Lecturer, Methodology of Political Science, 2nd Quarter 2026

Universidad de Talca, School of Public Policy and Public Administration, Chile

Teaching Assistant, Methods for Quantitative Research, 1st Semester 2017

Pontificia Universidad Católica, Institute of Political Science, Chile

Teaching Assistant, Politics and Social Movements, 2nd Semester 2016

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Political Theory, 2nd Semester 2013 and 2014

Pontificia Universidad Católica, Institute of Sociology, Chile

Teaching Assistant, Sociology of Public Opinion, 1st Semester 2017

Teaching Assistant, Gender Studies, 2nd Semester 2016

Teaching Assistant, Methods for Social Sciences II, 1st Semester 2016

Teaching Assistant, Political Sociology, 1st Semester 2016

Teaching Assistant, Qualitative Methods, 1st Semester 2015

Teaching Assistant, Formation and Development of Modern Society, 1st Semester 2014

Teaching Assistant, Formation and Development of Modern Culture, 2nd Semester 2013 and 2014

SUPERVISION

MA theses

2026 Sophie Kessler

BA theses

2026 2 Political Science Degree; 5 double degree Political Science and International Studies

**CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS**

2026 MPSA Annual Meeting (Online); Instituto Juan Linz Inaugural Conference (Madrid, Spain); EPSS Conference (Belfast, Northern Ireland); APSA Annual Meeting (Scheduled).

2025 MPSA Annual Meeting (Online); WIDER Development Conference (Helsinki, Finland); Jan Tinbergen European Peace Science Conference (Barcelona, Spain); EPSA Conference (Madrid, Spain); Fragile Lives Conference (Berlin, Germany); Life in Kyrgyzstan Conference (Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan).

2024 APSA Virtual Research Meeting (Online); MPSA Annual Meeting; EPSA Conference (Cologne, Germany); APSA Annual Meeting (Philadelphia, USA); Fragile Lives Conference (Berlin, Germany).

2023 6th International Conference on the Political Economy of Democracy and Dictatorship (Münster, Germany); APSA Annual Meeting (Los Angeles, USA); Annual Conference of the Institute for Social Movement and Protest Studies (Berlin, Germany).

2022 APSA Annual Meeting (Montreal, Canada); Elections, Public Opinion and Parties Conference (Newcastle, UK); EPSA Conference (Prague, Czech Republic); MPSA Annual Meeting (Chicago, USA).

2021 Society for Latin American Studies (SLAS) Annual Conference (Online); MPSA Annual Meeting (Online).

2018 Latin American Studies Association Congress (Barcelona, Spain).

2017 9th Chilean Congress of Sociology (Talca, Chile); Latin American Sociological Association Congress (Montevideo, Uruguay).

WORKSHOPS &
INVITED TALKS

2026 Elections & Political Parties in Africa and Latin America (University of Reading); Democracy and Political Violence Conference (Harvard University).

2024 Conceptualization of Protest Camps Logistic (Free University Berlin); Democratic Resilience Workshop, Centre for Elections, Democracy, Accountability and Representation (University of Birmingham); Multi-Data Perspectives on Democracy Workshop (GESIS Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences); Identity, Order, and Violence in the Post-Cold War. Open Society University Network (OSUN, invited talk).

2023 Comparative Politics Colloquium (University of Hamburg); Conflict & Change Annual PhD Workshop (University College London); Quantitative Political Economy Workshop (King's College London); Yet They Persist: Democracies in an Age of Autocratization (University of Milan); War Effects: The Micro-Level Effects of Civil Wars on Multiple Dimensions of Women's Empowerment (University of Bergen).

2022 Gender and Political Participation Graduate Working Group (online); Political Behavior Workshop Berlin-Hamburg (Humboldt University, Berlin); Internal colloquium (WZB, Berlin); Comparative Politics Colloquium (University of Hamburg).

2021 Internal Colloquium (NTNU, Norway).

2015 Social Movements in Movement: Concepts and Methods for the study of social movements in Latin America (Universidad de La República, Montevideo, Uruguay); Social movements and the state in the context of the 'left turn' in Latin America (University of Bath, United Kingdom).

PROFESSIONAL
ACTIVITIES

Peer Review: The Journal of Politics; European Journal of Political Research; Political Behavior; British Journal of Political Science; Journal of Elections, Public Opinion & Parties; Electoral Studies; Journal of Peace Research; Party Politics; Representation; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; Perspectives on Politics; Mobilization; International Journal of Public Opinion Research; Comparative Migration Studies; Asian Journal of Comparative Politics.

Memberships: American Political Science Association, Midwest Political Science Association, European Political Science Society, Latin American Studies Association, Women in Conflict Studies, Estudios de Género y Violencia en América Latina (eGAL) Network, Margherita von Brentano Center (FU Berlin).

Departmental/University Service: Organizer of Empirical Political Science in Progress Colloquium, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin (2022). Tutora Académica Internacional, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid (2026).

ADDITIONAL
INFORMATION

- Statistical Software: R, Python, Stata
- Other Software: L^AT_EX, Qualtrics, QuestionPro, NVivo, MaxQDA
- Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), German (TELC B1), Korean (basic)
- Citizenships: Chilean, German